My own notes on onboarding corporate customers (written for training juniors; no customer names).

1. Start with the registry. Check the latest annual filing date. A filing more than 18 months old is stale: request an updated filing before going further.
2. Resolve ownership layer by layer until you reach people. Anyone holding 25 percent or more, directly or through holding companies or trusts, is a beneficial owner.
3. Trusts: the settlor, trustees and any protector exercise control. If the settlor also sits on the board of the customer, treat that as circular control and note it.
4. Screen every director, beneficial owner, trustee and signatory against sanctions and PEP lists. A near match is cleared only on date of birth plus one other identifier, never on name alone.
5. Addresses: a registered office at a virtual office provider is not on its own a reason to decline, but it raises risk when combined with layered ownership.
6. Rate risk. Layered ownership through a trust plus any unresolved near match is high risk.
7. The analyst recommends; an authorised approver decides. High risk always goes to the approver with the findings listed.

Common junior mistakes: approving because each document looks fine on its own; missing the settlor as a beneficial owner; clearing a near match on name spelling.